Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
McKinney Public Library
City of McKinney
401 E. Virginia Street, McKinney, TX 75069

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Technician position with the McKinney Public Library. The duties that apply to every assignment are the ones I already do daily: taking materials in, shelving them, keeping the shelves orderly and accurate, and helping people find what they came for. The Community Engagement duties layered on top, planning programs and outreach and then evaluating whether they worked, happen to describe the other half of my current job.

My title is Direct Mail Production Manager at Young Americans for Liberty, and I manage the archive of every printed piece we produce. That means taking samples in from the printer, sorting and labeling them, shelving them by campaign and mail code, keeping the shelves accurate, and pulling what a writer or a director needs. When I inherited the collection I designed a SQL database for it, set a consistent record for each piece, cataloged several campaign years against that standard, and built a searchable interface over the top, so the whole department can find a past piece on its own.

The customer-facing duties are familiar ground. As a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law I staffed the service window as the first person students talked to, explaining procedures that were not obvious, making referrals, and processing more than five hundred transcripts and exam records accurately. At the University of Austin I was the on-site contact for visitor tours of the campus library, helping guests locate materials and answering their questions about the collections, and I handled the intake of the donated books that library was being built from, including a complete set of the *Harvard Classics*. I am also the person colleagues come to when a system will not cooperate, which is most of what helping somebody with a public computer or a printer actually is.

On the Community Engagement side, I run printed fundraising campaigns from concept through mail date. One might be a letter going out to the whole donor file, the next a proposal prepared for a single major donor, the next the invitation set for a conference, and most months several are moving at once. I coordinate the outside vendors and the internal departments producing each piece, hold every project to its date, produce the promotion that goes with it, and I have run registration, check-in and on-site logistics for conferences serving up to a thousand attendees.

Your posting lists evaluating the current program and outreach model, and that is work I already do. Everything we send gets measured afterward. How a conference invitation performed against the one before it, which fundraising letter earned a response and which did not, which audiences were worth going back to. I prepare that reporting for senior staff, and it decides what we run again and what we retire.

Outside work I built two public websites: the Free Knowledge Library, a digital library of political literature drawn from across the ideological spectrum, where I designed the site, the database and the classification scheme and built the catalog readers search; and StateTrack, which publishes state campaign finance records for all fifty states.

I am building toward this as a career rather than sampling it. I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification, and I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring, with a master's in library and information science to follow. I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I am in Austin now, and I am willing to move anywhere in Texas a position requires.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie